

Theta Lambda Chapter
Local Chapter Procedures Manual (LCPM)
Updated: 3/16/2025

Abbreviations

The following abbreviations shall be used as appropriate throughout this document:

- CPM – Chapter Procedures Manual
- GPA – Grade Point Average
- LCPM – Local Chapter Procedures Manual
- MIT – Member-in-Training
- SAI – Sigma Alpha Iota
- VPM – Vice President, Membership
- SAA – Sergeant-at-Arms
- NVPCC – National Vice President, Collegiate Chapters

Members

Chapter members must maintain a grade point average (GPA) as stated in the chapter bylaws, Article III, Section 4.B.3. A faculty advisor or university official must verify that each member meets the minimum GPA each semester once final grades are posted. This must be done each semester. The recording secretary communicates with the Department Chair who verifies that each members' GPA has met the minimum GPA requirement with a "yes" or "no".

- Each member must usher for a concert at least twice per year. The Corresponding Secretary may increase this requirement when needed.
 - Members are required to wear black professional attire while ushering for events held in McAlister Auditorium or at Daniel Chapel.
 - Members are required to wear badge attire while ushering for events held in Daniel Recital Hall.
- Each member must assist in receptions.
 - The minimum number of receptions responsibilities is 6 per year.
 - The Receptions Committee Head Chair may raise the requirement as needed after consulting with the Executive Board.
- Philanthropy:
 - Each member must take part in one local philanthropy event a semester.
 - Each member must take part in national philanthropy events as laid out by the National Philanthropy committee.
- Musicales:
 - All members are expected to participate in all chapter concerts as designated by the Song Leader. These concerts do not fulfill the musicale requirement.
- If a member is unable to fulfill any of the above requirements, she can request an alternative plan from the Executive Board.

- o Ex. A member may be allowed to perform more receptions in lieu of ushering events if necessary.

Attendance

- The fraternity attendance policies are stated on pages 4-10 and 6-6 of the Chapter Procedures Manual (CPM). The chapter will review these two CPM sections each semester. Members are expected to attend all chapter meetings and events unless they are excused.
- In addition to the four recognized reasons for excused absences listed in the fraternity attendance policy, members will be automatically excused for family emergencies.
- Members receive one free unexcused absence per semester, referred to as a "rose pass."
- Members requesting an excused absence must notify the President, Treasurer or Recording Secretary of their absence excuse.
- Excuses for reasons stated in the fraternity attendance policy will be accepted and approved by the President, Treasurer or Recording Secretary.
- Requests for absences for reasons other than those stated in the CPM and LCPM will be discussed by the Executive Board, then read to the chapter, and accepted or rejected by chapter vote.
- A written absence excuse must be emailed or submitted to thetalambdarecsec@gmail.com at least 24 hours prior to the event for planned absences, with illness excuses accepted up to one hour prior to the event.
- Social committee and other committees or officers may set an earlier due date for excuses if necessary for head counts or other planning purposes.

Non-compliance with attendance policies

- If a member does not comply with these attendance policies, the member must appear before the Executive Board and the chapter advisor to discuss the circumstances of their absences, and the Province Officer will be made aware of the situation. Any action coming from this meeting must be approved by the National Vice President, Collegiate Chapters (NVPCC), per the CPM, prior to execution.

Modified Attendance Plans

- Members who are unable to fully participate in chapter events for the semester may request a modified attendance plan. This can be due to student teaching, internship, academic reasons, health reasons, or other situations.
- A member may submit their written request for a modified attendance plan to the Executive Board at the beginning of the semester.
- Members with a modified attendance plan must pay national and local dues.
- Members with a modified attendance plan may participate in chapter events when their schedule allows.

Unaffiliated alumnae status

- If a member no longer wishes to participate in the chapter, they may request to be removed from the chapter's membership list. It is recommended that a meeting be held with the member, the faculty advisor and chapter President to discuss this transition. This request must be submitted before the deadline for national dues. After that date, the member will be responsible for paying any local or national dues billed by that time.
- This member will be removed from the active chapter roster and moved to unaffiliated alumnae status. An unaffiliated alumnae member is no longer a member of the chapter and may not participate in regular chapter activities except when specifically invited to attend. They may reactivate with the chapter later if they are still enrolled at the university and would like to resume participation with the chapter.

Chapter Dues

- Chapter dues are \$163 for the fall semester and \$63 for the spring semester.
- Local and national dues must be paid by the deadline set by the Treasurer.
- Each member must meet all other financial obligations to remain in good standing. Examples of further financial obligations include T-shirt costs, formal tickets.
- If dues are not paid in entirety by the end of the fraternity year, the member will be reported as Delinquent to National Headquarters.

Dues Payment Plan

- If a member cannot pay their dues in full by the due date, they must set up a payment plan with the Treasurer prior to the due date.
- If dues are not paid in full by the due date and other arrangements have not been made, the member will be considered not in good standing until all financial obligations are met.
- If a member does not pay their dues after setting up a payment plan, they must meet with the Executive Board and chapter advisor to discuss the circumstances of their outstanding dues. If the member still does not pay their dues, they will not be in good standing with the chapter.
- If a member misses a payment, the Treasurer will notify them by email within one week of the missed payment. If the member does not respond within two weeks of the written notification, either by making the payment or renegotiating their payment plan with the Treasurer, they will not be in good standing for financial reasons.
- If a member's circumstances change and they are no longer able to uphold their payment plan as written, they should contact the Treasurer immediately and revise the plan.

Reestablishing Good Standing

- Members who are not in good standing for financial reasons will return to good standing once the outstanding money is paid.

- Members who are not in good standing for **non-financial** reasons will return to good standing at the beginning of the next semester based on consultation with the executive board and advisors.
- Members who are not in good standing as result of missing a service project, required concert or recital may attend another event with the approval of the Executive Board, to return to good standing.
- Members who are not in good standing may request a meeting with the Executive Board and Chapter Advisor to discuss a plan to return the member to good standing.

Membership Recruitment

- The chapter will host a minimum of 3 recruitment events each semester.
- Prospective MITs must attend at least 2 recruitment events, including formal recruitment, to be considered for an invitation to membership. If an MIT has absence excuses allowable under the chapter attendance policies, they may work with the VPM to remain in consideration for membership.

Selecting Member-In-Training (MIT) Sponsors

- To serve as an MIT sponsor, a member must have completed one semester of membership, must attend 2 recruitment events, and must be in good standing.
- Sponsors for each MIT are selected by the VPM from a list of members who have volunteered.
- Members who have not served as a sponsor previously will be given the opportunity to serve according to order of graduation, then number of credit hours earned.
- After all members have had the opportunity to serve as a sponsor, members who have previously served as a sponsor will be given the opportunity to serve again chosen in order of times as a sponsor, from fewest times to most times.
- The VPM may ask sponsors their preference of which MITs they want to sponsor, but the VPM makes the final decision.

Members-In-Training

- MIT meetings are held weekly.
- Each MIT class will plan and carry out a service project.
- Profits made from MIT fundraisers are to be equally distributed to help pay for Collegiate Initiation Fees.
- Each MIT will participate in an MIT musicale for the chapter. Non-performing MITs can contribute to musicales in other ways such as preparing musicale programs, facilitating a music related presentation, acting as stage crew or emcee.

Officers

- All officers are required to attend officer training held by the Province Officer. Any officers who cannot attend must follow up with the Province Officer for review of any information missed.
- Duties of officers are as listed in the CPM. Additional duties are:

- o Corresponding Secretary supplies ushers for Furman University Music Department events and keeps the Google Drive clean and organized.
 - o Editor is the chairman of the Publicity Committee, creating and distributing all advertisements needed by the chapter.
- Outgoing officers must meet at least once with the incoming officers for successor training.
 - o Officer materials must be given to the new officer during successor training.
- It is recommended that outgoing officers provide incoming officers with a list of tips for the position, how they may have handled troublesome situations, and especially any unresolved issues that remain at the time of successor training.
- The outgoing Executive Board must meet with the incoming Executive Board after elections to discuss any issues and answer questions and concerns. Running a joint chapter meeting after Officer Installation is highly encouraged.
- If an officer is not performing satisfactorily, is rendered incapable of fulfilling their duties, or becomes delinquent, the officer must appear before the Executive Board and the chapter advisor to discuss their circumstances. The Province Officer will be made aware of the situation. Any action coming from this meeting must be approved by the Province Officer and NVPCC prior to execution.

Nominations and Elections

- It is recommended that a candidate for office must be a member of Sigma Alpha Iota (SAI) for a full semester.
- It is recommended that candidates for President and Treasurer have prior experience serving on the Executive Board.
- After the slate of officers is presented, each candidate may speak for up to two minutes. Following speeches, the candidates may be asked a maximum of 2 questions. The maximum time allowed for questions and answers is 2 minutes per candidate. All questions must be the same for each candidate for an office.

Executive Board

Executive Board meetings will be held on the dates and times as determined by the chapter at the start of each semester.

Meetings

Chapter meetings will be held on the dates and times as determined by the chapter at the start of each semester.

- The first chapter meeting of the month will be a formal meeting with a chapter musicale.
- It is recommended that a calendar of formal meetings be created at the beginning of each semester so that members can plan their schedules.
- Unless advised otherwise, meetings will be held in Room DMB003 of the Daniel music building.

Musicales

- Each member is expected to participate in a chapter musicale once per year. Non-performing chapter members can contribute to musicales in other ways such as preparing musicale programs, facilitating a music related presentation, acting as stage crew or emcee, or singing SAI songs with other members.
- Any music performed must be well prepared and rehearsed.

Badge Attire Statement

- Badge Attire is required at all formal meetings, ritual ceremonies and public performances sponsored by the chapter. The fraternity's Badge Attire Position is found on the Officer Portal. Additional badge requirements can be found in the CPM Chapter 18.
- If a member does not comply with badge attire at the required events, they will be asked to change into appropriate attire by the SAA.

Committees

- Duties of the committees are as listed in the CPM. Additional duties are:
 - Social Committee shall:
 - Organize events such as Semi-Formal and Formal.
 - Organize SAI's participation in homecoming.
- Fundraising shall:
 - Design a collection of Furman Music related apparels for sale.
 - Maintain an inventory of all merchandise.
 - Coordinate apparel sales opportunities with the Department of Music.
 - Organize and manage the Fermata Café fundraising event.
- Sisterhood shall:
 - Organize retreats for the chapter members.
 - Organize activities at chapter meetings meant to aid the members in learning about one another while fostering sisterhood bonding.
- Local Outreach shall:
 - Organize opportunities for members to meet their local philanthropy requirements.
- Receptions shall:
 - Contact all senior music performers presenting a recital, as well as the music department, to offer them the services of Sigma Alpha Iota receptions.
 - Make all food purchases for the receptions.
 - Organize members to staff the events.
 - Maintain an orderly receptions closet
- Song Leader shall:
 - Have conducting experience and work with pianists and vocal consultants within the chapter.
 - Teach the chapter new songs while refining older songs during Song Rehearsals.
 - Compile a binder of songs to be used during Local Philanthropy events.

- Theta Lambda Chapter is required to register as a student organization on campus. The chapter President must contact Furman University Office of Student Involvement via SyncDin (Campus Organizations Portal) to register.

LCPM Updates

This Local Chapter Procedures Manual must be updated and approved by the chapter each fall and must be attached to the Collegiate Chapter Bylaws Report due November 1. Changes may be proposed at a regular meeting and voted upon at the next meeting at least 48 hours later. A two-thirds affirmative vote of the chapter members in good standing is required. If updates are made to the document after the November 1 report deadline, the chapter distributes the approved updated version to all members and submits a copy of the updated LCPM on the Officer Portal using the form LCPM – RESUBMISSION ONLY.